

SIMATS ENGINEERING

ASSESSMENT TOOL 3

COURSE NAME: Database Management Systems

COURSE CODE: CSA0501

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO4: *Design database solutions incorporating file organization, indexing, and hashing techniques to optimize data storage and retrieval efficiency. (BL3, BL4)*

Activity Tool : Comparative Analysis (Low)

Assessment Tool Weightage: 10%

QUESTIONS		
Q.No	Question	Bloom's Level
1	Compare sequential file organization and heap file organization in terms of data insertion, deletion, and retrieval efficiency.	Bloom's Level: 4 – Analyze
2	Differentiate between clustered indexing and non-clustered indexing with suitable database examples.	Bloom's Level: 4 – Analyze
3	Compare primary indexing and secondary indexing based on storage requirements and search performance.	Bloom's Level: 4 – Analyze
4	Analyze the differences between static hashing and dynamic hashing in database systems.	Bloom's Level: 4 – Analyze
5	Compare B-Tree indexing and B+ Tree indexing for large-scale database applications.	Bloom's Level: 4 – Analyze

6	Differentiate linear hashing and extendible hashing in terms of bucket management and scalability.	Bloom's Level: 4 – Analyze
7	Compare dense indexing and sparse indexing with respect to memory usage and access speed.	Bloom's Level: 4 – Analyze
8	Analyze the advantages and limitations of indexed sequential file organization versus direct file organization.	Bloom's Level: 4 – Analyze
9	Compare single-level indexing and multi-level indexing for efficient database retrieval operations.	Bloom's Level: 4 – Analyze
10	Evaluate the performance of hashing techniques and indexing techniques for exact-match and range queries in databases.	Bloom's Level: 5 – Evaluate

Code of Conduct:

I D. Gnana Deepthi(192411123) (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment.

I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the student:



ANSWERS

1. Sequential File Organization vs Heap File Organization

Aspect	Sequential File Organization	Heap File Organization
Insertion	Slower because records must be inserted in the correct sequence/order.	Faster because new records can be added wherever free space is available, usually at the end.
Deletion	Slower because deleting a record may require rearranging records or maintaining the sequence.	Faster because the record can simply be marked as deleted or removed.
Retrieval	Very efficient for sequential access and range-based searches because records are ordered.	Efficient for retrieving all records, but slow for searching for a particular record without an index.
Search	Faster when searching in the ordering field; binary search can be used.	Usually requires a linear search, making individual searches slower.
Maintenance	Requires maintaining the sorted order, which increases overhead.	Simple to maintain because no ordering is required.
Best suited for	Applications requiring sequential processing and range queries.	Applications with frequent insertions and simple record storage.

2. Clustered Indexing vs Non-Clustered Indexing

Feature	Clustered Indexing	Non-Clustered Indexing
Data Storage	Determines the physical order of records in the table.	Does not change the physical order of records.
Number per table	Usually only one clustered index because data can have only one physical order.	Multiple non-clustered indexes can be created.
Search Speed	Very fast for range queries and sequential access.	Fast for specific searches but may require an additional lookup to fetch the actual row.

Feature	Clustered Indexing	Non-Clustered Indexing
Storage	Index is closely associated with the actual data storage.	Index is stored separately and contains pointers/references to the actual records.
Range Queries	Highly efficient.	Generally less efficient than clustered indexing for large ranges.
Example	Student(Student_ID, Name, Department, CGPA) with a clustered index on Student_ID.	Same table with a non-clustered index on Department.

Example

Suppose we have:

Student_ID	Name	Department	CGPA
101	Ravi	CSE	8.5
102	Anu	ECE	9.1
103	Kiran	CSE	8.8
104	Priya	IT	9.3

Clustered index on Student_ID:

- The actual student records are stored in Student_ID order.
- Searching for students with IDs from 101 to 103 is efficient.

Non-clustered index on Department:

- A separate index stores department values and references to the corresponding records.
- Searching for all students in CSE can use this index without physically rearranging the table.

Conclusion: Clustered indexing is suitable when data is frequently accessed in sorted or range order, while non-clustered indexing is useful for supporting multiple search conditions on different columns.

3. Primary Indexing vs Secondary Indexing

Feature	Primary Indexing	Secondary Indexing
Definition	Index created on the primary key or ordering key of a sorted file.	Index created on a non-ordering field of a file.
Data Ordering	Data records are physically ordered according to the index field.	Data records are not necessarily ordered according to the indexed field.
Storage Requirement	Requires less storage because it is usually a sparse index with one index entry per block.	Requires more storage because it is generally a dense index with entries for records or groups of records.
Search Performance	Very fast because the index is small and binary search can be applied efficiently.	Fast, but may require additional pointer/reference lookups to locate the actual record.
Number of Indexes	Usually one primary index for a sorted file.	Multiple secondary indexes can be created on different attributes.
Example	Index on Student_ID when records are sorted by Student_ID.	Index on Department or CGPA when records are not physically ordered by these fields.

Example

Consider a **Student** table:

Student_ID	Name	Department	CGPA
101	Ravi	CSE	8.5
102	Anu	ECE	9.1
103	Kiran	CSE	8.8
104	Priya	IT	9.3

Primary Index:

If records are sorted by Student_ID, the primary index may contain:

101 → Block 1

103 → Block 2

Since one index entry can represent a block, it requires **less storage**.

Secondary Index:

If an index is created on Department, it may contain:

CSE → 101, 103

ECE → 102

IT → 104

This requires **more storage**, especially when many records have the same value.

4. Static Hashing vs Dynamic Hashing

Feature	Static Hashing	Dynamic Hashing
Definition	Uses a fixed number of buckets throughout the file's lifetime.	Number of buckets can increase or decrease as the data changes.
Bucket Size	Fixed.	Can grow dynamically.
Handling Growth	Performance may decrease when the file grows.	Handles database growth efficiently.
Collisions	More collisions may occur as buckets become full.	Reduces collisions by splitting or adding buckets.
Overflow	Uses overflow buckets when the main bucket becomes full.	Usually minimizes overflow through bucket splitting.
Performance	Good for databases with a relatively fixed size.	Better for databases with frequently changing sizes.
Storage	Simple and requires less management overhead.	Requires additional storage and management for dynamic structures.
Complexity	Easy to implement and maintain.	More complex to implement.
Example	A student database with a fixed number of 100 buckets.	An e-commerce database where customer records continuously increase.

Example

Suppose a hash function is:

$$h(\text{key}) = \text{key} \% 5$$

In **static hashing**, there are always **5 buckets**. If many records map to the same bucket, overflow buckets are created.

In **dynamic hashing**, new buckets can be created when existing buckets become full. The records are redistributed to maintain efficient access.

Advantages and Disadvantages

Static Hashing

- **Advantages:** Simple, fast, and low management overhead.
- **Disadvantages:** Performance decreases as the database grows due to overflow and collisions.

Dynamic Hashing

- **Advantages:** Adapts to database growth and reduces overflow problems.
- **Disadvantages:** More complex and requires additional overhead for bucket splitting and restructuring.

5. B-Tree vs B+ Tree Indexing

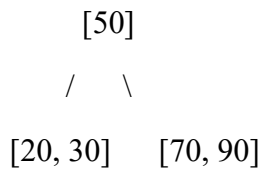
Feature	B-Tree	B+ Tree
Data Storage	Stores keys and actual record pointers/data in both internal and leaf nodes.	Stores keys in internal nodes and record pointers/data only in leaf nodes.
Search	Search may finish at an internal node.	Search always proceeds to a leaf node.
Range Queries	Less efficient.	Highly efficient because leaf nodes are linked.
Sequential Access	Comparatively slower.	Faster due to linked leaf nodes.
Fan-out	Lower because internal nodes store data pointers.	Higher because internal nodes store only keys and pointers.
Tree Height	May be slightly greater.	Usually smaller due to higher fan-out.
Disk I/O	More disk accesses may be required.	Fewer disk accesses are generally required.

Feature	B-Tree	B+ Tree
Complexity	Relatively more complex for range traversal.	Efficient and well suited for range traversal.
Large Databases	Suitable, but less commonly preferred.	Widely preferred for large-scale database indexing.

Example

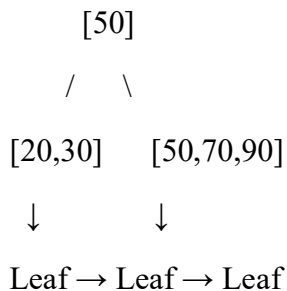
Consider an employee database indexed by Employee_ID.

B-Tree:



Keys and record pointers can exist in both internal and leaf nodes.

B+ Tree:



All actual record pointers are stored at the **leaf level**, and the leaf nodes are linked. Therefore, a query such as:

```
SELECT * FROM Employee
```

```
WHERE Employee_ID BETWEEN 50 AND 90;
```

can be performed efficiently by locating the first matching leaf and then following the linked leaf nodes.

6. Linear Hashing vs Extendible Hashing

Feature	Linear Hashing	Extendible Hashing
Bucket Management	Buckets are split gradually and sequentially .	Buckets are split based on hash values, and a directory is used to manage them.
Directory	Does not require a directory.	Requires a directory containing pointers to buckets.
Bucket Splitting	One bucket is split at a time according to a predefined split order.	A bucket is split when it overflows; the directory may also need to expand.
Scalability	Grows smoothly without sudden restructuring.	Can grow rapidly by doubling the directory size when required.
Memory Overhead	Lower because no directory is maintained.	Higher because of the directory.
Overflow Handling	Overflow chains may temporarily occur before a bucket is split.	Bucket splitting generally reduces overflow quickly.
Complexity	Relatively simple to implement.	More complex because of directory management.
Best Suited For	Databases that grow continuously and need gradual expansion.	Applications requiring very fast direct access and efficient overflow handling.

7. Dense Indexing vs Sparse Indexing

Feature	Dense Indexing	Sparse Indexing
Index Entries	Contains an index entry for every record .	Contains index entries for only some records , usually one per block.
Memory Usage	Higher , because many index entries are stored.	Lower , because fewer entries are stored.
Access Speed	Faster because the index directly identifies the required record.	Slightly slower because after finding the appropriate index entry, the block may need to be searched.

Feature	Dense Indexing	Sparse Indexing
Search	Very efficient for individual record searches.	Efficient, but may require additional sequential searching within a block.
Storage Requirement	Requires more disk space.	Requires less disk space.
Maintenance	More costly to update when records are inserted or deleted.	Easier to maintain because fewer index entries exist.
Example	An index entry for every Student_ID.	One index entry for each data block containing the first Student_ID.

8. Indexed Sequential File Organization vs Direct File Organization

Feature	Indexed Sequential File Organization	Direct File Organization
Access Method	Supports both sequential and direct access using an index.	Provides direct access using a hashing function or address calculation.
Search Speed	Fast because an index helps locate the required record.	Very fast for exact-match searches because the record address is calculated directly.
Sequential Access	Highly efficient because records are stored in sorted order.	Less efficient for sequential processing because records may not be stored sequentially.
Range Queries	Excellent for range queries.	Generally poor for range queries because hashing does not preserve order.
Insertion	Can be slower because the sorted order must be maintained.	Usually fast, although collisions may require additional handling.
Deletion	More complex because indexes and file ordering may need maintenance.	Relatively simple, but deleted spaces may need to be managed.
Storage Overhead	Requires additional storage for indexes and overflow areas.	Requires less index overhead but may require overflow space for collisions.

Feature	Indexed Sequential File Organization	Direct File Organization
Scalability	Suitable for large files, but index maintenance increases as data grows.	Scales well for exact-match operations if the hash function distributes records evenly.
Main Limitation	Index and overflow-area maintenance can be expensive.	Cannot efficiently support ordered or range-based searches.

9. Single-Level Indexing vs Multi-Level Indexing

Feature	Single-Level Indexing	Multi-Level Indexing
Definition	Uses one index table to locate records in the data file.	Uses multiple levels of indexes, where one index points to another index.
Search Speed	Fast for small indexes, but slows down when the index becomes large.	Faster for large databases because higher-level indexes reduce the search space.
Memory Usage	Requires less memory for small files.	Requires additional storage for multiple index levels.
Disk I/O	May require more disk accesses for a large index.	Requires fewer disk accesses because the search is performed hierarchically.
Index Size	Can become very large as the number of records increases.	Each higher-level index is smaller than the level below it.
Scalability	Suitable for small and medium-sized databases.	Highly suitable for large-scale databases.
Complexity	Simple to implement and maintain.	More complex to implement and maintain.
Example	One index directly points to data blocks.	Level 1 points to Level 2, which points to the data blocks.

10. Hashing vs Indexing for Exact-Match and Range Queries

Hashing and indexing are important techniques used to improve database retrieval performance. Their efficiency depends on whether the query is an exact-match query or a range query.

Feature	Hashing	Indexing
Exact-Match Query	Very fast , usually close to $O(1)$ average time.	Fast, generally $O(\log n)$ with B/B+ Tree indexes.
Range Query	Poor , because hash values do not preserve the order of keys.	Very efficient , especially with B+ Tree indexes.
Data Ordering	Does not maintain ordering.	B/B+ Tree indexes maintain sorted key order.
Collision Handling	Required when multiple keys map to the same bucket.	No hash collisions; tree structure manages keys.
Insertion	Fast on average. Dynamic hashing handles growth efficiently.	Efficient, but tree restructuring may be required.
Storage	Requires buckets and possibly overflow space.	Requires additional space for index nodes and pointers.
Best Use	Exact searches such as WHERE Student_ID = 101.	Exact and range searches such as WHERE CGPA BETWEEN 8.0 AND 9.0.
Large Database Performance	Excellent for exact-match operations.	Excellent for both exact-match and range operations.

RUBRICS FOR CALCULATION:

Criteria	Weightage (%)	Level 4 (Exemplary)	Level 3 (Proficient)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 1 (Beginning)
Scope of Items	20%	Selects highly relevant items with clear scope and justification	Selects appropriate items with minor gaps	Selection is limited or partially relevant	Items are unclear or not relevant
Comparison Depth	25%	Provides detailed and comprehensive comparison across multiple aspects	Provides adequate comparison with some depth	Limited comparison with few aspects	Very minimal or no comparison
Use of Evidence	20%	Supports comparison with accurate data, examples, or references	Uses some supporting evidence with minor gaps	Limited or weak supporting evidence	No supporting evidence provided
Critical Thinking	20%	Demonstrates strong critical thinking with clear interpretation and reasoning	Shows reasonable interpretation with minor gaps	Basic interpretation ; lacks depth	No meaningful interpretation
Clarity of Presentation	15%	Well-organized, clear, and logically structured presentation	Generally clear with minor issues	Somewhat unclear or poorly structured	Disorganized and difficult to understand